

#KIFT 2026 Agenda & Key Questions

Session I

Augmented Creativity: AI as the Co-Pilot for Fashion Creation

This session dives into the paradigm shift occurring at the very genesis of fashion: the design studio. As generative AI evolves from a novelty into a sophisticated "creative co-pilot," it is fundamentally altering how designers research trends, visualize concepts, and develop collections. This panel will explore the practical workflows of human-AI collaboration—examining how tools like sketch-to-image rendering, virtual prototyping, and automated tech packs compress timelines from weeks to hours without replacing the human emotional core. Attendees will discover how designers can leverage algorithmic insights as a sounding board to push creative boundaries, optimize fabric utilization, and bring highly experimental concepts to life faster than ever before.

Three Key Questions

1. What are the primary technical and collaborative barriers to ensuring that a photo-realistic, AI-generated 2D fashion concept can seamlessly translate into exact, production-ready 3D rendering, pattern layouts, and physical textile specifications?
2. When using generative models that are trained on vast, publicly available datasets, how can design teams fine-tune AI co-pilots on their own archives to ensure the generated concepts strictly respect the brand's unique historical DNA rather than diluting it into generic industry trends?
3. As the boundary between human intuition and algorithmic generation blurs, how should the fashion industry navigate the legal and ethical landscape of copyright ownership for a collection co-designed by a human designer and an AI co-pilot?

Session II

Thriving in the Future: Agentic AI & Physical AI in the Fashion Ecosystem

This session explores the intersection of high-end craftsmanship and advanced automation, focusing on how Physical AI (embodied robotics) is redefining the luxury and fashion industry. As brands navigate the delicate balance between heritage and technological evolution, this discussion will examine the deployment of intelligent robotics across the fashion value chain—from precise, automated material handling and delicate textile manipulation in production to sensory-driven, personalized experiences in luxury fashion retail. Attendees will gain insights into how intelligent machines can co-exist with and elevate human experience, driving operational efficiency without compromising the brand exclusivity, tactile quality, and emotional storytelling that define the luxury ecosystem.

Three Key Questions

1. How can Physical AI overcome the bottleneck of non-rigid material manipulation to automate the sorting, handling, and micro-fulfillment of delicate fashion goods within unpredictable, high-velocity supply chains?
2. In an industry where luxury is defined by human connection and storytelling, how can collaborative robots (cobots) be integrated into flagship retail spaces to enhance the customer experience without making the interaction feel cold or overly transactional?
3. How can brands leverage Physical AI in smart factories to enable scalable, on-demand hyper-personalization (e.g., bespoke tailoring and custom embroidery) while maintaining the rigorous quality, consistency, and high standards?

Session III

Circular Value Chain: AI-Driven Engagement and Lifetime Value Maximization

This session addresses the shift from static consumer transactions to continuous, data-driven brand relationships, highlighting how predictive AI is rewriting the rules of customer engagement. From AI assistants anticipating client needs before they are articulated to algorithmic clienteling tools that cultivate deep post-purchase affinity, the discussion will focus on strategies that move beyond mere satisfaction to dramatically boost lifetime value (CLV). This session also addresses the evolution of consumer relationships from linear transactions to sustainable, circular life cycles, highlighting how predictive AI unlocks value in the post-purchase ecosystems. Attendees will learn how leading luxury houses utilize intelligence engines to build sustainable, deeply humanized connections that turn one-time shoppers into lifelong brand advocates.

Three Key Questions

1. Instead of focusing AI purely on the pre-sale conversion funnel, how can brands leverage predictive machine learning models in post-purchase ecosystems—such as tailored care instructions, circular resale curation, or exclusive tier-based experiences—to sustainably maximize customer lifetime value?
2. What are the technical and operational boundaries of using computer vision and digital product passports (DPPs) to instantly authenticate pre-owned luxury items, thereby eliminating friction for the consumer and maintaining brand integrity in secondary marketplaces?
3. How can luxury brands leverage predictive AI to design exclusive post-purchase experiences (such as priority access to archival collections or customized digital styling for recycled-upcycled garments) that turn secondary market buyers into primary market brand advocates?